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God Is Self-Existent

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God Is Self-Existent

He depends on nothing for His being; He is the great “I AM.”

The Divine Name (Exodus 3:13-15)

When Moses asked for God’s name, the Lord said, “I AM that I AM.” He told Moses to say, “I AM has sent me to you.” God does not name Himself by what He depends on. He names Himself by what He is. The bush that burned and was not consumed makes the same truth visible: life that does not feed on what it touches.

Life in Himself (John 5:26)

Jesus said, “For just as the Father has life in himself, so he has granted the Son to have life in himself.” Created life is received. God’s life is not. The Father has life in Himself. The Son has life in Himself. This is self-existence within the life of God, not life borrowed from the world.

The Word Before All Things (John 1:1-3)

“In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.” Before anything was made, the Word already was. He is God, not a creature. He was with God, not a solitary force. God did not come into being when the world began, and He was not completed by making us. He was already God in communion—full in Himself.

God Needs Nothing (Acts 17:24-25)

Paul declared that the God who made the world “does not live in temples made by human hands. Neither is he served by human hands, as though he needed anything, since he himself gives to all mankind life and breath and everything.” He gives. He is not supplied. Worship does not replenish Him. It receives from Him.

Before All Things, Holding All Things (Colossians 1:17; Hebrews 1:3)

“He himself is before all things, and all things are held together in him.” Hebrews adds that the Son “sustains all things by his powerful word.” God upholds the universe by His own power and remains independent of it. Creation leans on Him. He does not lean on creation.

Daily Impact

Understanding that God is self-existent helps us live with greater humility and thankfulness for our very existence. It reminds us that we depend completely on Him for every breath, every heartbeat, and every blessing. This truth gently breaks the illusion that we need to be self-reliant. It invites us to surrender daily to Him in prayer, in our decisions, and in our relationships.

When we face times of need—whether financial pressure, emotional weariness, or spiritual dryness—we can turn to the God who lacks nothing and expect Him to intervene in our circumstances.

It changes how we work: instead of anxious striving, we learn to become faithful stewards. This truth also protects us from idolatry, reminding us not to look to money, success, or other things for the security that only God can give. In our relationships, it helps us move from dependence on people to investing in others through sacrificial love.

With this understanding, it becomes natural to thank God daily and fully trust Him. It builds a strong faith that holds steady even in difficult seasons, because we know our lives are safely held by the God who needs nothing yet cares for us completely. We learn to live as dependent creatures who find real meaning, security, and freedom because of our relationship with our self-sufficient Creator.

Because God is self-existent, I will fully depend on Him, knowing nothing, including me, exists apart from Him.

Questions for Personal Application

1. How can the truth of God's self-existence free me from anxious striving and self-reliance this week?
2. In what specific area of need (financial, emotional, physical, or spiritual) can I practice turning to God as the One who lacks nothing?
3. How should God's self-existence change the way I pray—especially when I feel empty or overwhelmed?
4. In my relationships, where am I looking to people for the security and fulfillment that only the self-sufficient God can provide?
5. How can I cultivate daily rhythms of gratitude and trust that remind me I am a dependent creature held by a self-existent Creator?

Word Pictures of God's Self-Existence

The Eternal Fountain

Do not picture a fountain fed by hidden pipes. Picture water that rises because it *is* water—never gathered, never replenished, never in danger of running dry.

God is that Fountain. No spring lies behind Him. No rain fills Him. No reservoir stands upstream. He does not draw life from another source, because He *is* the Source. From Him living water goes out toward all that He has made. Creation drinks and lives. The Fountain is not lessened. He overflows from His own fullness, not from any gift returned to Him.

So when you come empty, you are not coming to a cistern that waits on rain. You are coming to the God who has life in Himself, and who gives without first being supplied.

Unborrowed Light

The moon is bright, but it is not a source. It shines with light that belongs to another. If that light were withdrawn, the moon would go dark.

God is not the moon. He does not shine with borrowed glory. No other lamp stands behind Him. No greater life lends Him being. He is Light, not a reflection. All that lives receives its brightness from Him. He receives His being from no one.

That is self-existence made visible: not a brighter creature, but the Source whose life is His own.

Reflection

The Fountain needs no pipes, no rain, no return gift. We drink. He is not lessened.

1. Where am I still treating God as a cistern—as if He must be filled before He can help me?
2. When I come empty, do I come to receive from His fullness, or to bargain as if I were supplying Him?
3. What would change this week if I believed that the Fountain overflows from Himself, and that my need cannot exhaust Him?

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Thank you again for partnering with us in the Great Commission. May the Lord continue to fill you with joy, peace, and purpose as you walk with Him.

In Christ,

The JesusOnline Ministries Team

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